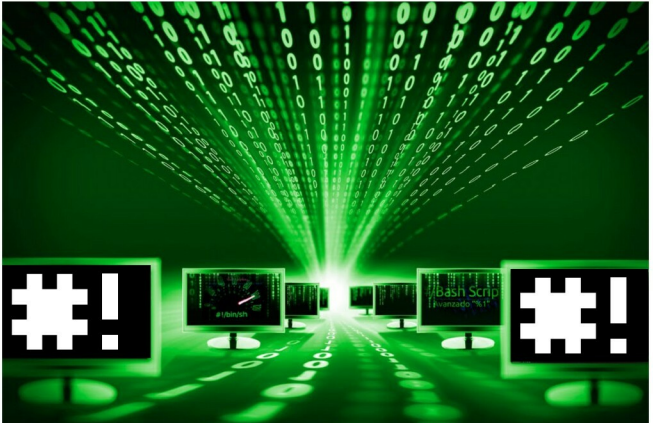


SHC Shell Script Compiler: An Introduction

The generic shell script compiler (SHC) can hide source code, which is useful in preventing accidental erasures, alterations and deliberate, mischievous and malicious tampering. It also converts shell scripts directly into binaries.



Often, we need to hide shell script code to prevent unintentional modification and hide sensitive information in scripts like passwords. There are tools such as *obfusc* and *shellcrypt* available to hide source code.

SHC stands for the generic shell script compiler.

Created by Francisco Javier Rosales García, it converts shell scripts directly into binaries, compiles scripts, hides source code, protects against accidental changes and hides sensitive data in script.

How it works

SHC creates a stripped binary executable version of the script specified with *-f* on the command line. The binary version will get a *.x* extension appended, and will usually be a bit larger in size than the original ASCII code. Generated C source code is saved in a file with the extension *.x.c*.

Here, I have chosen the Centos 6.7 version (equivalent: RHEL 6.7) with minimal installation in the virtual box. To install the required packages for compiling SHC from the source code, execute the command below on a terminal with root privileges:

```
#yum groupinstall "Development Tools"
```

Or, give the following command:

```
#yum install make gcc gcc-c++ kernel-devel
```

Installation

Download the latest source code tar package for *shc*, for that first *install wget* package: